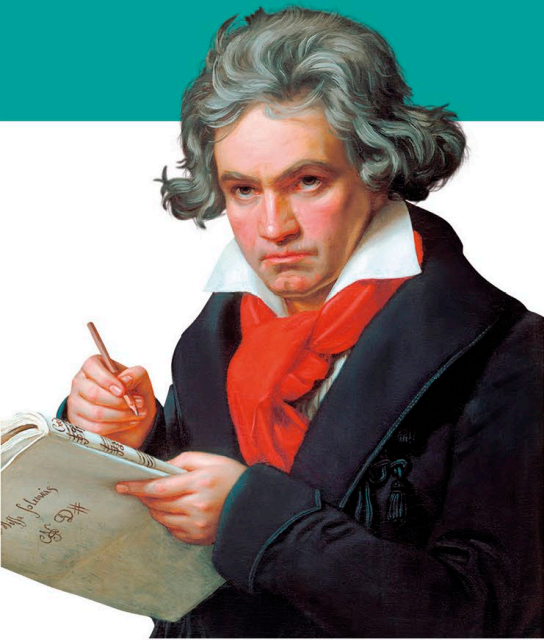




1805 Musical masterpiece

German composer Ludwig van Beethoven's *Symphony No. 3* was performed for the public for the first time, in Vienna, Austria. Grand and more dramatic than other symphonies of the time, it marked the beginning of the Romantic era in music.

1795 Measuring in metric

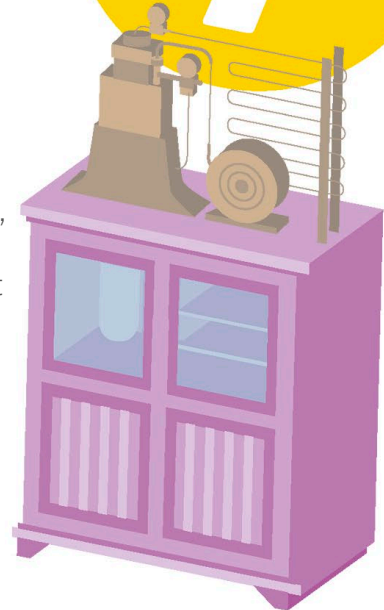
France became the first country to officially adopt the metric system, which defined units of length, mass, and volume based on the dimensions of Earth.



1913

Keeping food cool

After making some improvements to the industrial refrigerator, US inventor Fred W Wolf filed a patent for his new design. He manufactured a simple, inexpensive fridge that could be plugged into the household electric supply.



Born this day

1954 Jackie Chan, Hong Kong-born Chinese film star. He is best known for mixing dangerous acrobatic stunts with comedy. He popularized kung fu in Hollywood and has starred in many movies.

Also on this day

1827 A year after inventing friction matches, British chemist John Walker started selling them in his shop.

1927 US Secretary of Commerce Herbert Hoover made the first public demonstration of a videophone, using it to call officials of the American Telephone & Telegraph company (AT&T), the creators of the device.

1987 The National Museum of Women in the Arts in Washington, DC, USA, opened to the public, displaying its vast collection of artworks by women.

April

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